Complete Guide: Creating a Meta Developer App, Generating ID and Access Tokens

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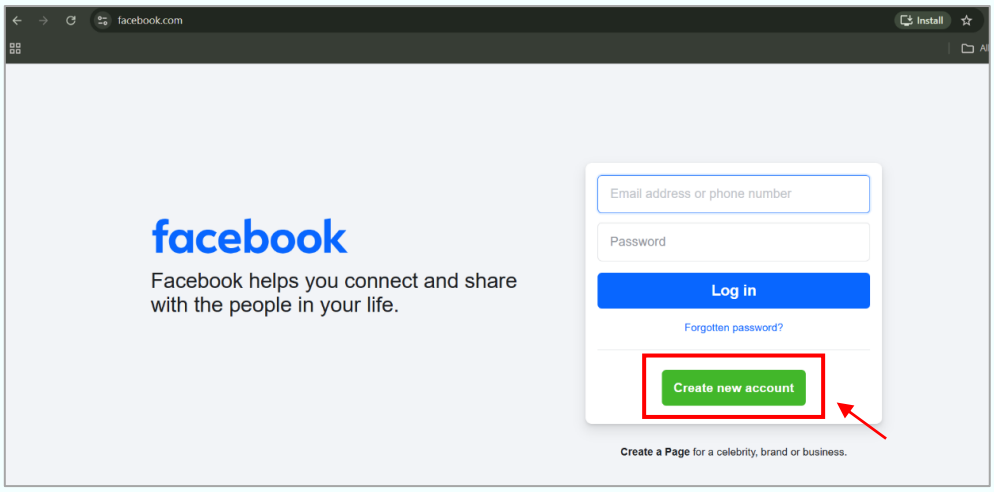
0. Pre-requisites

- A personal Facebook account (used as admin/owner – not public).
- A Facebook Page for your business.
- An Instagram Business or Creator account.
- Your Instagram Business account linked to the Facebook Page.

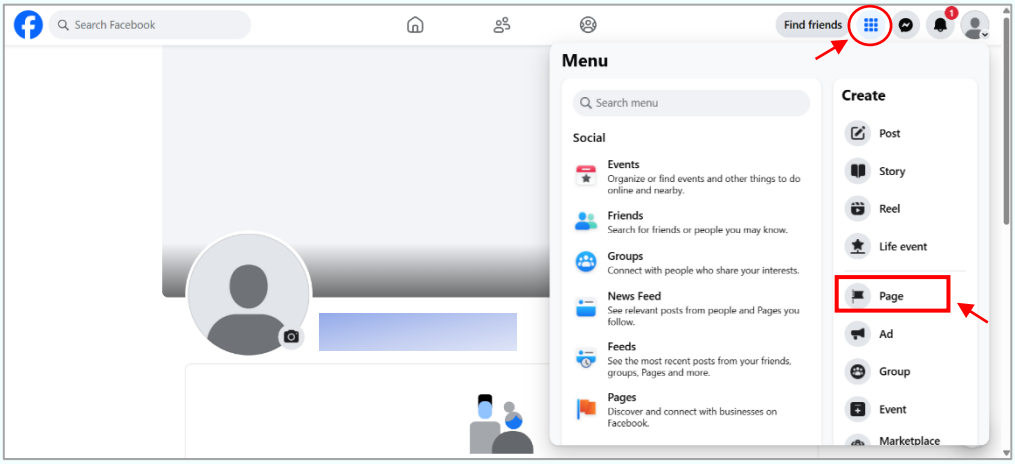
1. Create Facebook Account and Business Page

1.1 Create your Facebook account with a business page

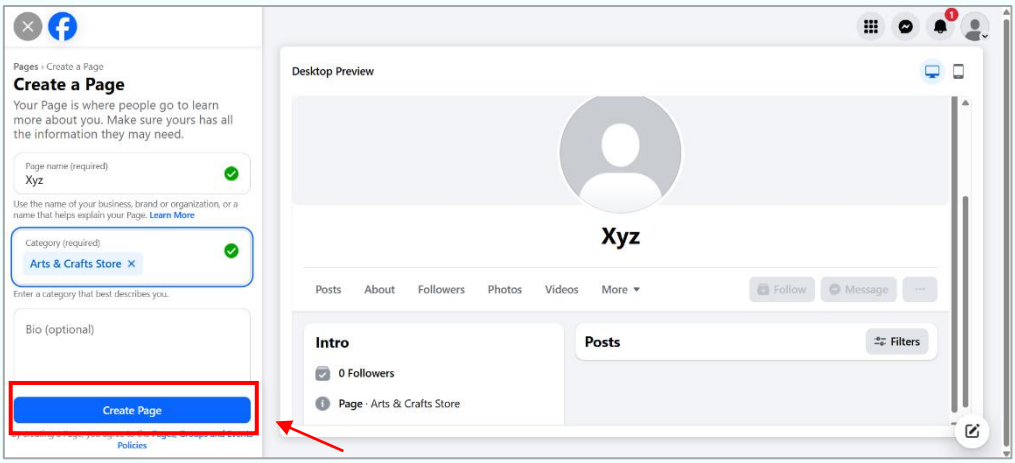
- Go to Meta Business: https://facebook.com
- Log in with your personal Facebook account (if already have an account).
- Or Click Create account.



- Enter: Your name, email and password
- Click Submit.
- Now, In Settings (gear icon):
  - Go to Accounts → Pages as shown in the fig. below.

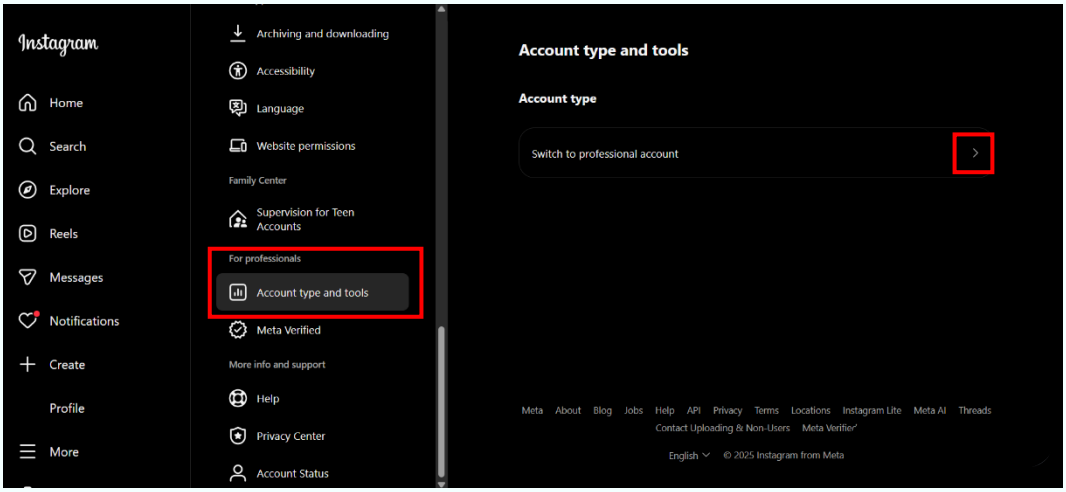


- Choose one:
- Add existing Page (if you already have one).
- Create a new Page (if you don't) as shown in the fig. below.

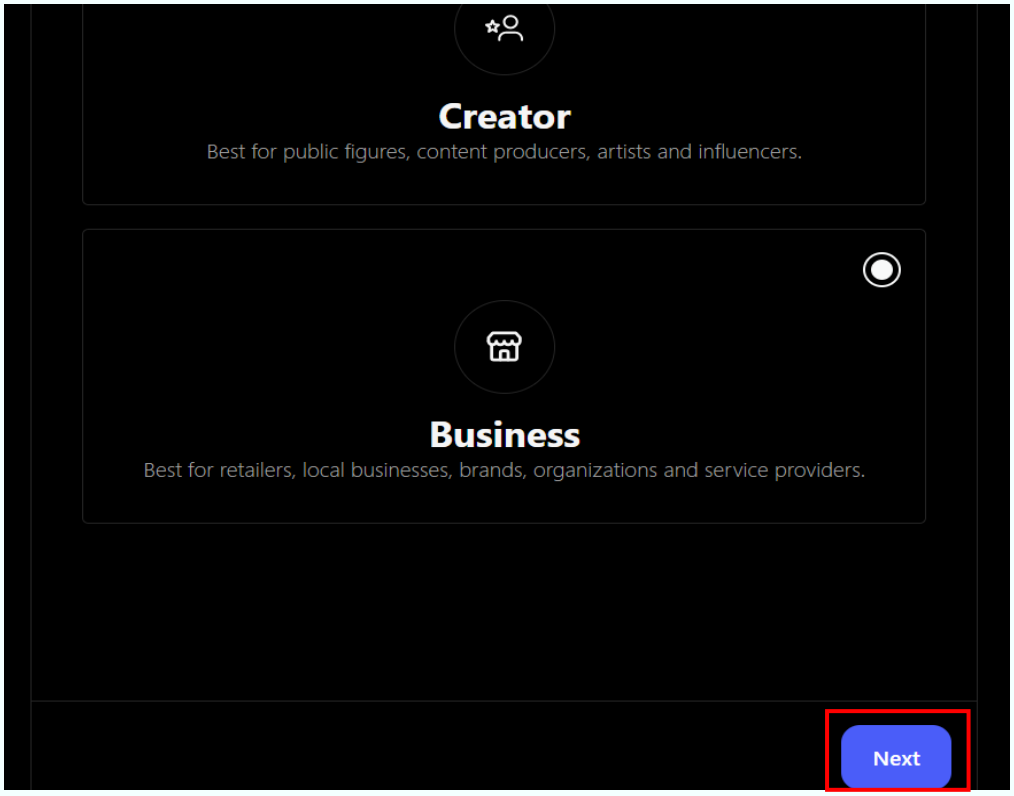


2. Create / convert Instagram Business account & link it to Facebook

- Create your profile on Instagram then, Go to your profile.
- Tap ☰ (menu) → Settings and privacy.
- Look for Account type and tools under "For professionals".
- Tap Switch to professional account as shown in below fig.

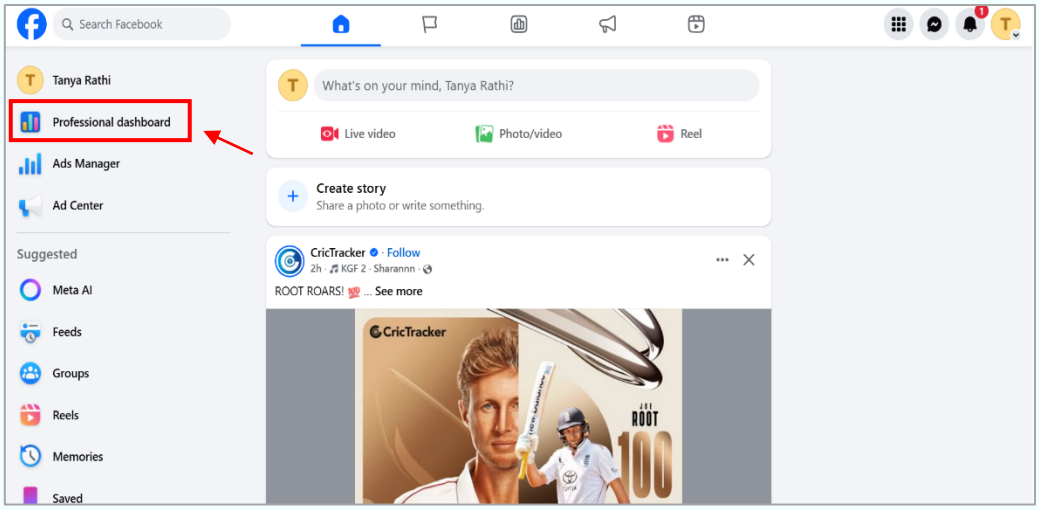


- Choose Business (or Creator if that's your use case) as shown in below fig.
- Then, Complete the setup (category, contact info, etc.).

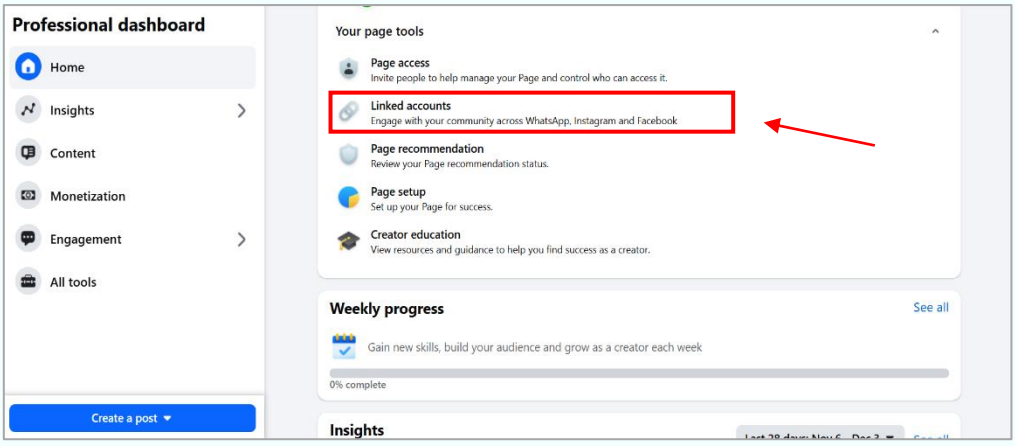


2.1 Link Instagram Business to your Facebook Page

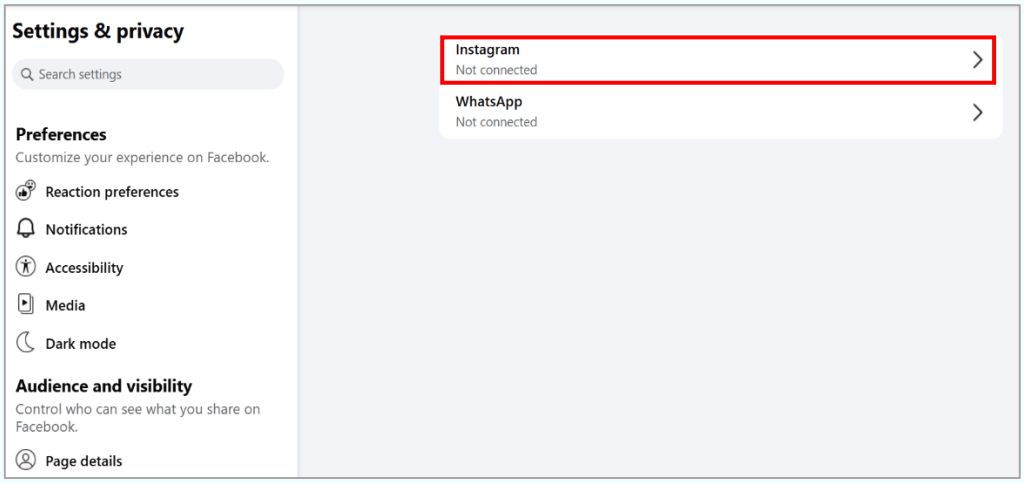
- From Instagram: Go to your Facebook business profile.
- Under Profile at home page, click Professional dashboard, find Page as shown in the below fig.



- Click on Linked Accounts as shown in below next fig.



- Tap on Instagram to connect or create Instagram account with the Facebook Page.
- Select your existing Facebook Page or create one.

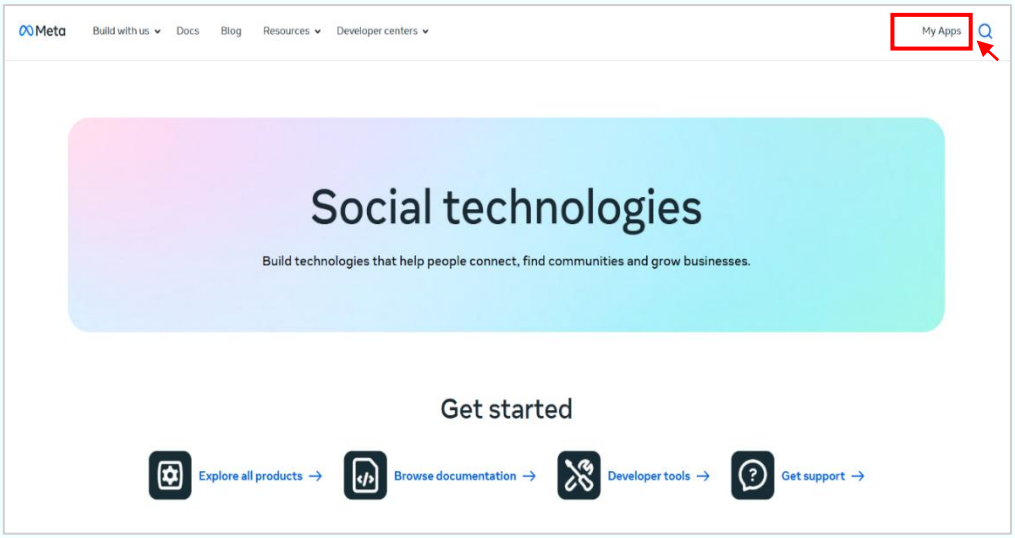


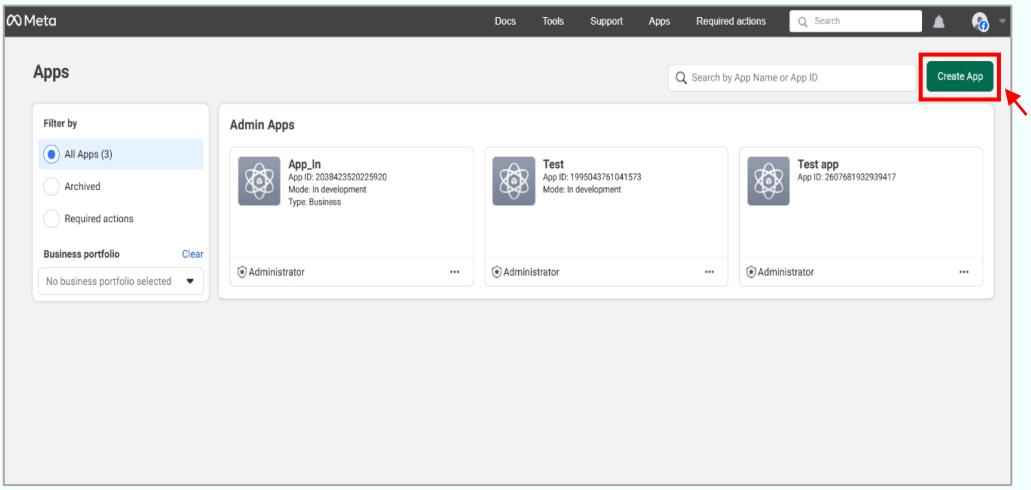
- Confirm the connection by clicking continue for each dialog box.

This link is mandatory for using the Instagram Graph API with Meta apps.

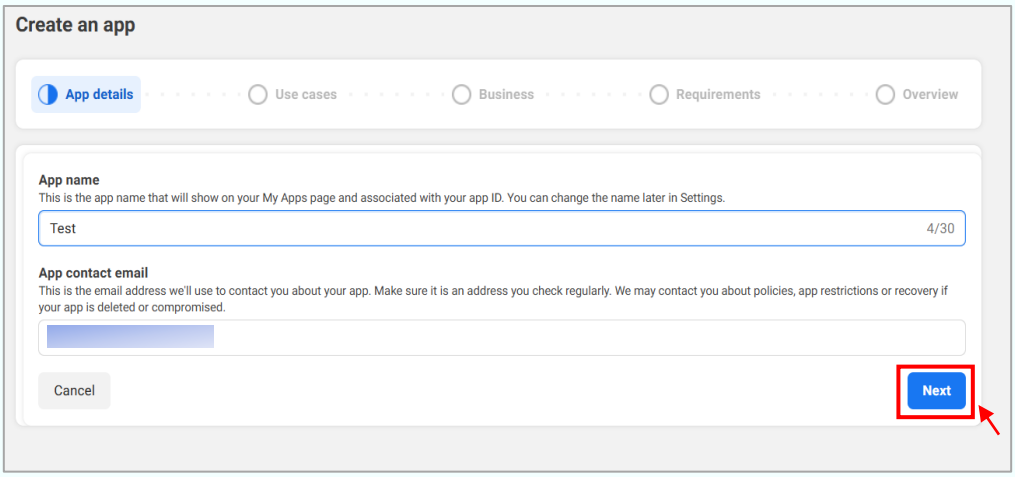
3. Create a Meta Developers app

- Go to Meta for Developers: https://developers.facebook.com
- Log in with the same Facebook account.
- In the top-right, click My Apps → Create App as shown in below fig.

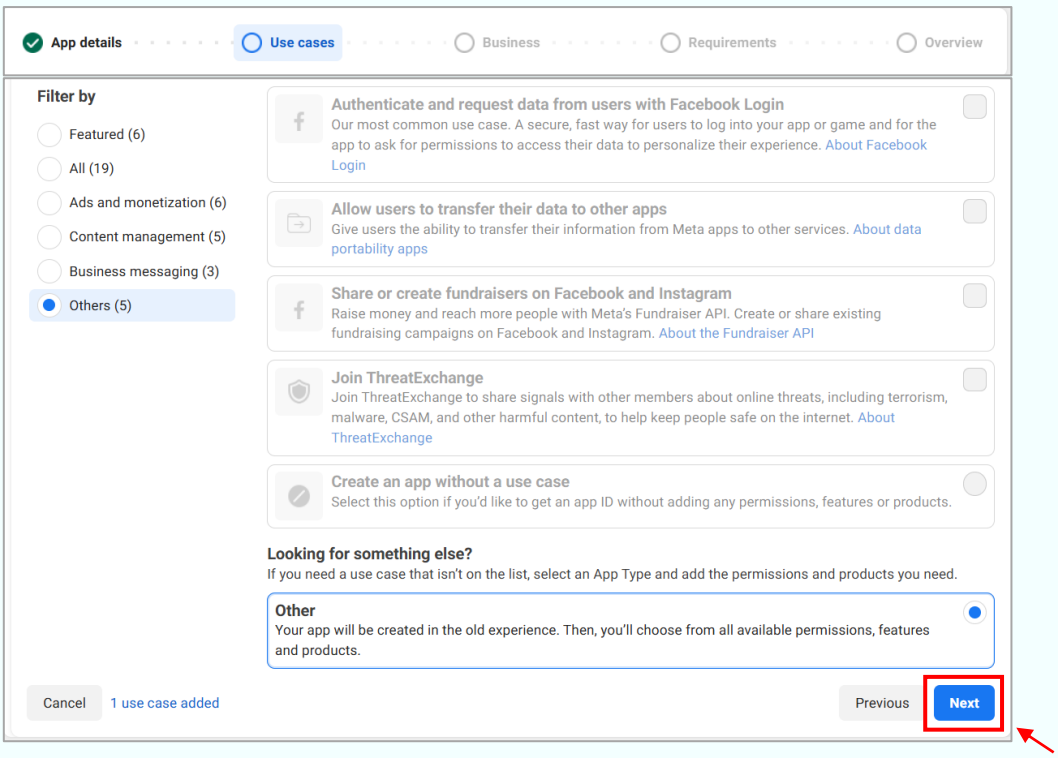


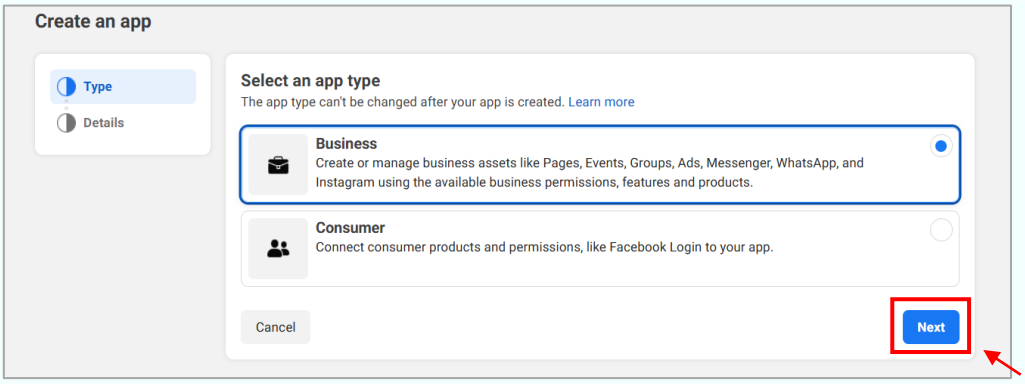


- Now, Give App name and App contact email as shown in fig. below.

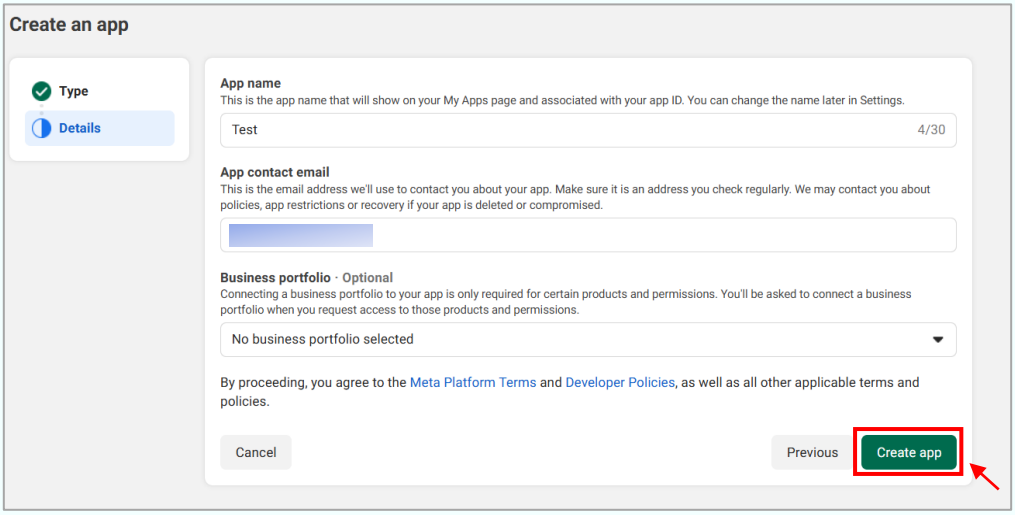


- Choose use case as “Others” or “Create an app without use-case” then select app type as “Business” as shown in the fig. below.





- Enter: App name, contact email, Business account (default) as shown in below fig.



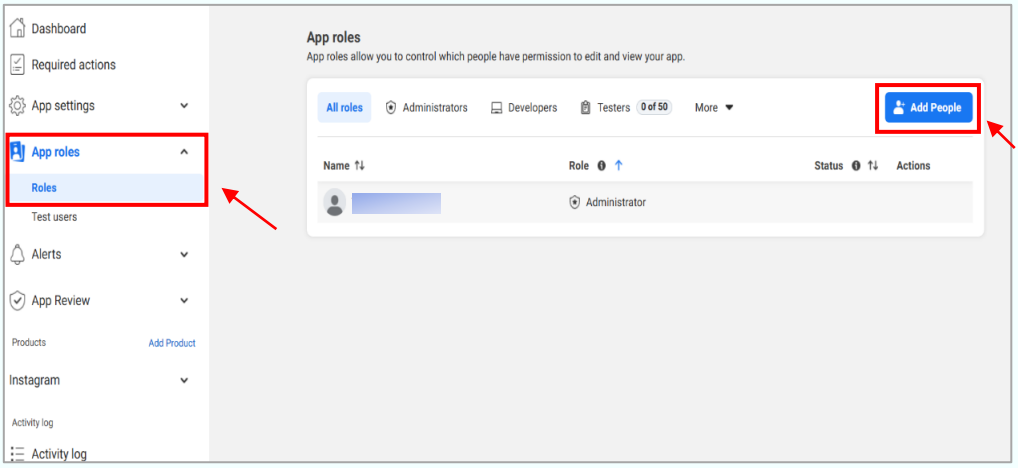
- Click Create app.
- In the App Dashboard → Settings → Basic: Note your App ID and App Secret.

4. Adding products into the Meta Developer App

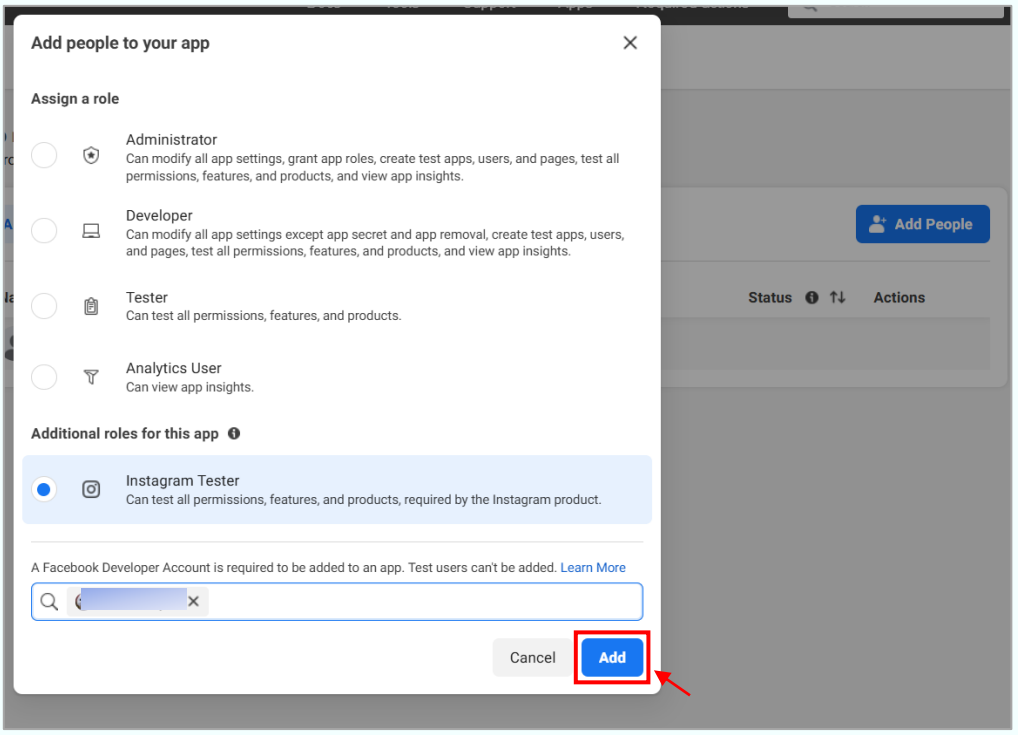
4.1 Adding Instagram API (Instagram Graph API with Login)

Meta's newer docs show Instagram API with Instagram Login & Instagram API with Facebook Login options.

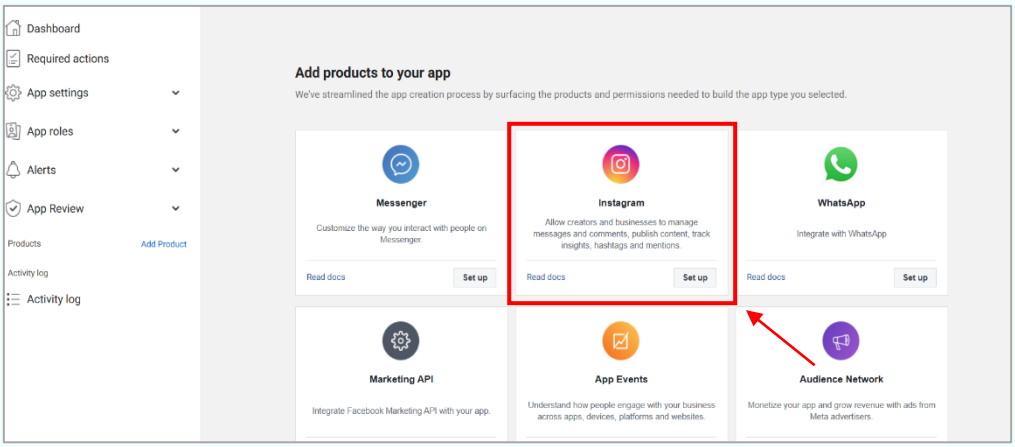
- For Instagram API setup, first add Instagram API as product then, we will give Instagram Tester role to the Instagram account.
- Go to App Roles and then grant/add the role for your Instagram username as shown in the below fig.



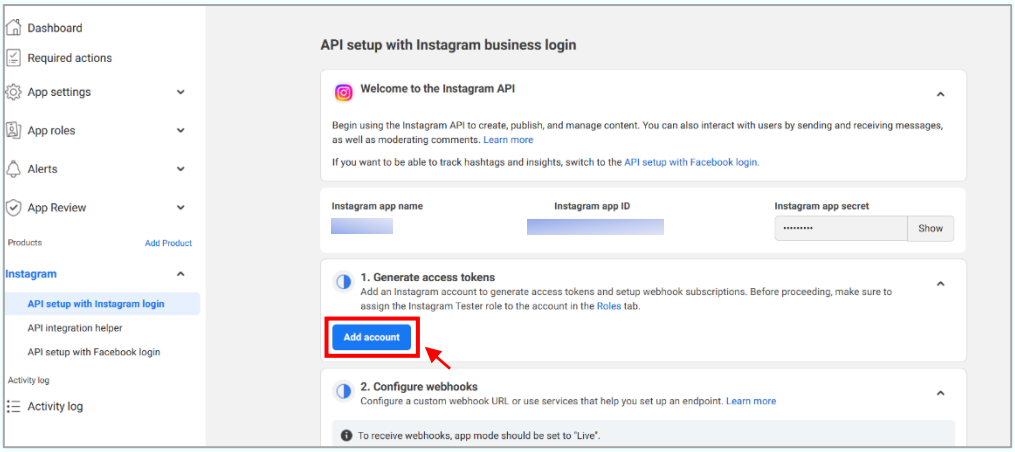
- Now assign the Instagram tester role to the user via user id as shown in the fig. below.



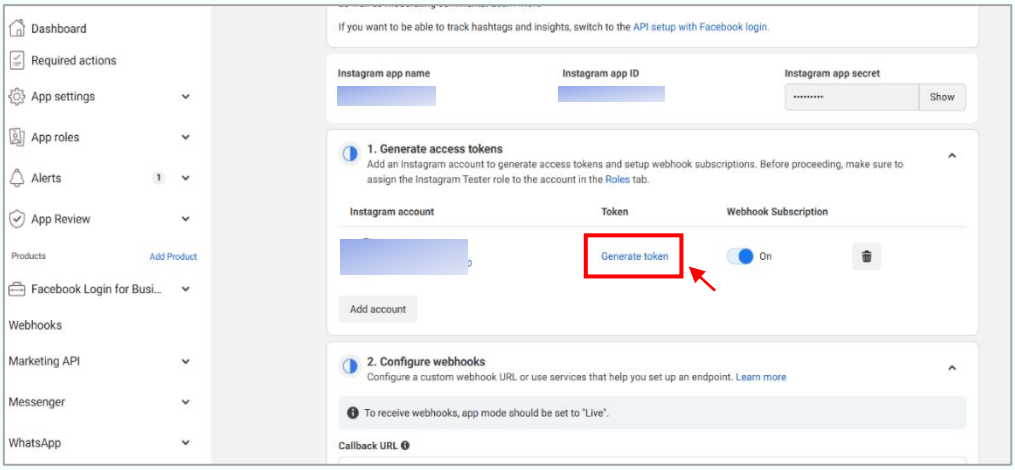
- Now in the App Dashboard, under Add products or Added products:
- Look for Instagram / Instagram API.
- Click Set Up as shown below in the fig.



- For login-based flows, add your Instagram account as told in the below figure.



- This will add Instagram → Basic settings / API setup sections to your app.
- You should see a Generate token button. Click it.



- Meta will generate a long-lived Instagram user access token (often already 60-day). Copy and safely store it (server-side).

We can then use it to call the Instagram Graph endpoints, e.g.:

```
→ GET https://graph.instagram.com/me
  ?fields=id, username
  &access_token={GENERATED_TOKEN}
→ GET https://graph.instagram.com/me/media
  ?fields=id, caption, media_type, media_url, permalink, thumbnail_url, timestamp
  &access_token={GENERATED _TOKEN}
```

5. Configure permissions (scopes) [Optional]

In App Dashboard → Instagram → Settings / API setup and App Review → Permissions & Features, we'll typically need (depending on use case):

Common Instagram Graph permissions:

- instagram_basic or instagram_business_basic
- instagram_graph_user_profile
- instagram_graph_user_media
- instagram_manage_comments (if you'll manage comments)
- instagram_manage_insights (for insights/analytics)
- pages_show_list
- pages_read_engagement

→ For development, we can test with: Our own account

→ For production, Meta will require App Review with a clear description and screencast of how you use these permissions. [Optional]

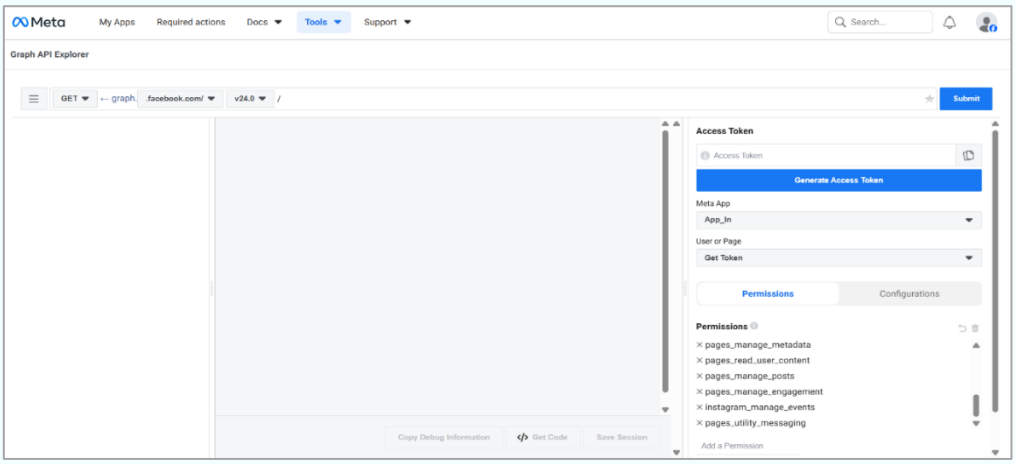
6. Generate Instagram User ID, Page ID and Page Access Token

Now, we have an Instagram Graph API Access token already generated above. For generating Page ID and Page Access token we need requirements like:

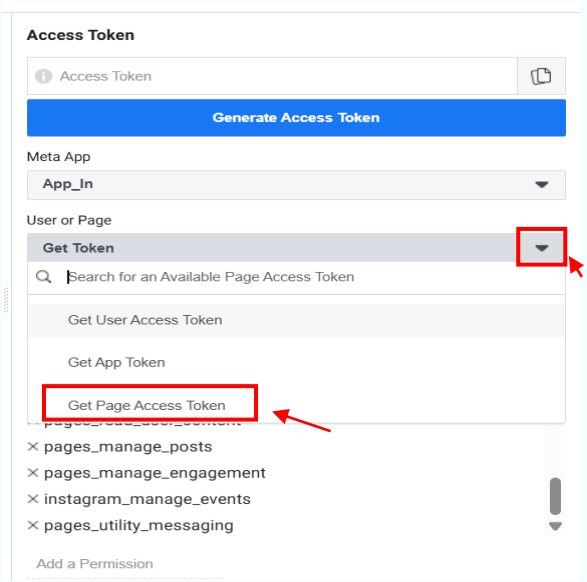
- Instagram account = Business or Creator (Already done)
- Instagram account is connected to a Facebook Page (Already done)
- Instagram User Access token has permissions:
    - pages_show_list
    - pages_read_engagement
    - instagram_basic

- instagram_manage_insights

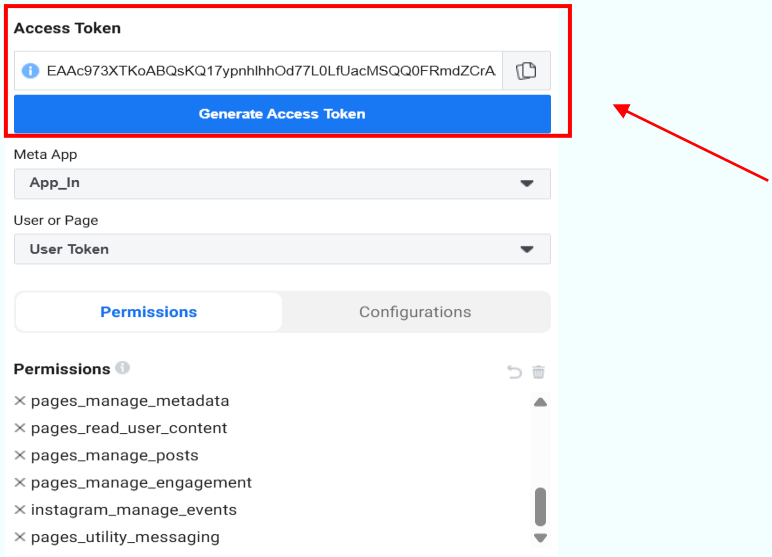
Step 1: Go to Meta for Developers: https://developers.facebook.com/tools then open Graph API Explorer, something like below will open in fig.:



Step 2: Then, Click on User or Page Get Token dropdown and click on Get Page Access Token.



Step 3: Then, Reconnect your account. After that we will see some generated token here:



Step 4: Now using that FB User Access Token and the below command in the bar to generate FB page ID:

→ GET https://graph.facebook.com/v24.0/me

In this way, we can able to get the FB Page ID and Username.

Step 5: Now we request some permissions on the User token, then exchange it for Page to make it page access token as below:

- pages_show_list
- pages_read_engagement
- instagram_basic
- pages_manage_metadata
- pages_manage_engagement
- pages_manage_posts
- instagram_content_publish
- read_insights
- read_page_mailboxes
- pages_messaging
- instagram_manage_comments
- instagram_manage_insights
- instagram_manage_messages
- pages_read_user_content
- instagram_manage_events

- pages_utility_messaging

After those permissions, click again on generate token and finally by doing this we can able to get Page Access Token.

Step 6: Now using that Page Access Token and the below command in the bar to generate Instagram User ID:

```
→ GET https://graph.facebook.com/v24.0/me/instagram_accounts
```

In this way, we can able to get the User ID.

That’s it! By following all the above steps, Meta Developer app is now configured and our access token is ready. We can now start implementing and testing our solution using the generated credentials.